

Outlook

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Card blocks need a customer-harm view

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Card blocking protects customers, but repeated legitimate attempts and later complaints may reveal controls that are too blunt. Please start with the decision we need to make, then show whether the available evidence is strong enough to support it.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if ordinary PIN errors create avoidable blocks?
2. What evidence would instead support that blocked cards follow genuinely unusual sequences?
3. How do we rule out that customers receive inconsistent recovery paths?

We looked at a version of this before. For the December 2020 review, please show what changed and whether the earlier conclusion still holds. Please work towards where thresholds, escalation or customer communication should change. A useful output would be a control view with the exceptions, owner and reason each item was included.

Use ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: Do not label a block as incorrect without the rule decision and investigation outcome.

Regards